



THE COPPERBELT UNIVERSITY

DIRECTORATE OF DISTANCE EDUCATION AND OPEN LEARNING

ASSIGNMENT ONE (TOTAL MARKS=100)

Competence-Based Group Assessment Question

Course: Management Accounting 1
Individual Assignment

Assessment Mode: Field-based + Analytical

Permitted Resources: Class notes, prescribed textbook, field data collected .

Explicit Restriction: Use of AI tools, content generators, or automated software for answering is strictly prohibited.

Assessment Scenario

Each student shall **physically identify a real, local organization** micro, small, or medium enterprise, service unit, institution, or production unit

No two students may study the same organization.

Task

You are appointed as a **cost accounting study team** to analyze the **actual cost structure and practices** of the chosen organization **based on direct observation, interviews, and manual records**.

Part A: Understanding Cost Accounting in Practice (In-Person Evidence Required)

1. In your own words, explain:
 - What **costing** means in the context of the selected organization.
 - The **functions of cost accounting** actually performed (or missing) in the organization.
2. Prepare a **hand-drawn comparison table** showing **Cost Accounting vs Financial Accounting** based on:
 - Actual documents used
 - Actual decisions taken by managers

Attach **photographs of source documents** (with sensitive data masked).

Part B: Cost Accounting Terminology Based on Observation

From your field study:

1. Identify and justify:
 - One **cost centre**
 - One **revenue centre**
 - One **profit centre**
 - One **investment centre**
2. Specify:
 - Actual **cost units** and **cost objects**
 - A **manual cost coding system** currently used or proposed
3. Explain how responsibility centres function **based on managerial roles you observed or discussed**.

Part C: Classification of Costs Using Real Data

Using **actual expense data** collected:

1. Classify costs into:
 - Direct and indirect
 - Elements of cost
 - Fixed, variable, semi-variable
 - Functional costs
 - Product and period costs
2. Identify:
 - Green costs and blue costs actually incurred

- ESG-related costs (or justify absence)
- 3. From the same data, identify:
 - Discretionary costs
 - Avoidable and unavoidable costs
 - Sunk and committed costs

Each classification must be supported by real figures and justification obtained from the organization.

Part D: Cost Behaviour Analysis Using Manually Collected Data

1. Select one **semi-variable cost** (e.g., electricity, maintenance, transport).
2. Collect **monthly data for at least 6 months** from the organization.
3. Using **manual calculations** (no software regression):
 - Apply the **High–Low Method**
 - Apply the **Scatter Graph Method (hand-drawn)**
4. Compare the results and explain **which method aligns better with the organization's operations**, based on your understanding from field interaction.

Part E: Accounting for Raw Materials and Inventory Practices

1. Describe how:
 - Raw materials are purchased, stored, issued, and recorded.
2. Apply **two stock valuation methods** manually using **actual quantities and prices** from stock records.
3. Observe and document:
 - Stock taking procedure
 - Stock management system in practice (or absence thereof)
4. Recommend **practical, low-cost improvements** suitable for that organization.

Part F: Individual report (Mandatory)

Each student must submit a **handwritten reflection** (200 words) on:

- What they personally observed
- What confused them initially and how they resolved it
- One insight that cannot be found in textbooks

Submission Requirements

- Detailed report
- Field visit evidence (photos, notes, signatures)

- Raw data sheets